Independent director candidate

Allison Alimayu, PhD

Audit, enterprise risk, and regulatory oversight, tested as an elected regent of a multi-billion-dollar public system

Board materials | November 2026

Earlier work appears under her former name, Allison Stephens



She has governed at multi-billion-dollar scale, rebuilt audit and risk oversight, and designed control systems from the ground up

1 **Fiduciary oversight at scale**

Elected regent of the Nevada System of Higher Education, a multi-billion-dollar system of eight institutions that run like cities. Vice chair and audit committee chair, 2013 to 2019.

2 **Audit and enterprise risk, rebuilt**

Redesigned the audit and enterprise risk framework, directed a $25 million reserve distribution, and cut open audit exceptions by 68 percent.

3 **Operator's command of the numbers**

Twelve years at UnitedHealthcare and DaVita; designed a five-state payment program averaging $8.5 million in monthly savings.

4 **System design and risk mitigation**

Designed SAFE, a governance framework for a national research funder that builds a control for each of six risks.

5 **National governance**

Eight years and two elected terms on the Democratic National Committee, the party's national governing body, with officer roles in its Black Caucus and its Environmental and Climate Crisis Council.

6 **Regulatory depth**

Federal appointee to Medicare's MEDCAC; commissioner, North Carolina Oil and Gas Commission.

By the numbers

Multi-billion
Dollar public system governed as an elected regent

68%
Reduction in open audit exceptions

$25M
Reserve distribution directed as audit committee chair

$8.5M
Average monthly savings, five-state payment program

8 years
On a national governing board, two elected terms

15
Boards, commissions, and councils since 2010

Sources: Nevada System of Higher Education Board of Regents records, 2013 to 2019; UnitedHealthcare and DaVita Integrated Care program reporting, 2006 to 2018.

Governing a public university system required every competency a corporate board screens for; federal and state seats add regulatory depth

Competency	NSHE Board of Regents 2013 to 2019	Managed care finance 2006 to 2018	SAFE framework 2025 to 2026	MEDCAC 2019 to 2027	NC Oil and Gas Commission 2026 to 2030	Democratic National Committee 2016 to 2024	Nonprofit boards 2012 to 2021
Audit and financial oversight	●	●	◑	○	◔	◔	◑
Enterprise risk management	●	◑	●	◑	◕	◑	◔
Regulatory and compliance	●	◑	◕	●	●	◑	◔
Executive oversight and accountability	●	◔	◑	○	◑	●	◕
Real estate and capital projects	●	○	○	○	◔	○	◔
Investments and capital allocation	●	◑	◕	○	○	◔	◔
Strategy and system design	●	●	●	◔	◔	◕	◑
Data, technology, and analytics Validating the evidence behind decisions; IT oversight	●	●	●	◕	◔	◑	○
Healthcare and life sciences	●	●	◔	●	○	◑	◑
Energy, environment, and climate	●	○	○	○	●	●	◑

Depth of direct responsibility: ● Led ◕ Substantial ◑ Shared ◔ Exposure ○ None

As a regent of a multi-billion-dollar, eight-institution system, she rebuilt audit and risk oversight and cut open audit exceptions by 68 percent

1 The mandate

Elected in November 2012 to the governing board of the Nevada System of Higher Education, a multi-billion-dollar public system. Served January 2013 to January 2019.

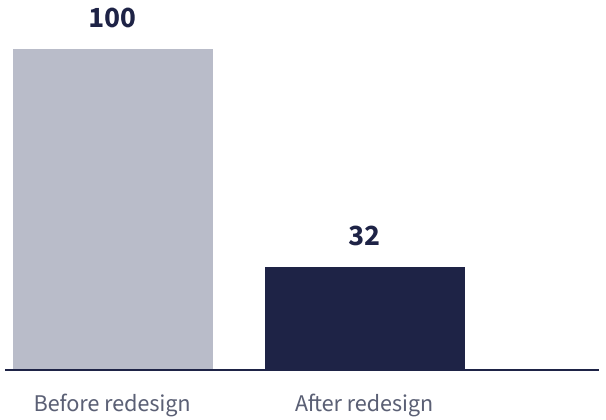
- 2 research universities
- 1 state university
- 4 community and state colleges
- 1 research institute

The board holds fiduciary oversight of the chancellor and system executive leadership.

2 What she did

- Chaired the Audit and Compliance Committee; vice chair of the board, December 2016 to June 2017; member of the Budget and Finance, Investment and Finance, and Health Sciences System committees
- Led a redesign of the system's audit and enterprise risk management framework
- Built a staffing model that paired auditors with subject matter experts in each key area of enterprise risk, including health compliance
- Directed a $25 million distribution from the Operating Pool Reserve to clear a backlog of internal audit follow-up

3 Results



68% fewer open audit exceptions. Distinguished Public Service Award, 2019.

Open audit exceptions indexed to 100 at the start of the redesign. Published on audit committee governance in the College and University Auditor Journal and Trustee Quarterly; presented at the Association of College and University Auditors national conference.

Scope of the regent role

A university system runs like a set of cities, so the board she served on oversaw the same enterprises a Fortune 500 board does

Real estate and capital projects

Land sales, lease-purchase financing, and campus construction, from academic buildings to student housing

Corporate analogue: capital allocation, facilities, real estate portfolio

Investments and endowment

Endowment and operating portfolios; weighed a 2018 fossil fuel divestment review and chose not to divest

Corporate analogue: investment committee, pension, and climate risk in capital allocation

Public lands, energy, and climate

Nearly 14,000 acres of land-grant farms, ranches, and research lands, plus campus energy and climate commitments

Corporate analogue: land and natural resource stewardship, sustainability, climate risk

Health sciences enterprise

A new medical school, medical and dental practices, an autism center, student health, and rural health workforce programs

Corporate analogue: health system operations and reimbursement risk

Athletics and public venues

Coaching contracts, stadium agreements, and events that bring the wider community onto campus

Corporate analogue: executive contracts, venue and event liability

Housing, child care, and safety

People live, work, and play on campus: residence halls, child care centers, Title IX, and campus police consolidation

Corporate analogue: workforce, duty of care, and compliance

Data and technology

The data behind every policy vote, system-wide information systems, and technology efforts she led

Corporate analogue: data governance, IT and cyber oversight

Executive search and oversight

Chaired a community college presidential search; oversight of the chancellor and presidents

Corporate analogue: CEO succession and evaluation

Budget and people

Biennial operating budgets, tuition and fees, and compensation for faculty and executives

Corporate analogue: operating plan, pricing, and compensation committee

Audit, risk, and compliance

As committee chair: the audit and enterprise risk framework across every enterprise above

Corporate analogue: audit and risk committees

Nevada System of Higher Education: two research universities, a state university, four community and state colleges, and a research institute. Source: Board of Regents records, 2013 to 2019.

Health sciences oversight

The board also governed a full health sciences enterprise: building new schools, running clinical practices, and training the state's health workforce

1 Built

- A new public medical school, the UNLV School of Medicine, from planning through its first class in 2017
- Nevada's first public physician assistant program
- New health degree programs, including nursing, addiction and behavioral health, and speech-language pathology

2 Oversaw in operation

- Medical school faculty practices that deliver patient care, and their finances and debt
- Dental school clinics serving the public
- The UNLV Medicine Ackerman Autism Center, opened in 2016
- Student health programs across eight institutions

3 Workforce and access

- Residency and fellowship expansion to keep physicians in Nevada
- Rural health, including rural family medicine training
- Nursing and allied health pipelines, and shared health sciences facilities

Board relevance
Health care delivery and provider operations, clinical quality and liability, reimbursement, workforce supply, and the regulatory risk that health care, life sciences, and employer boards carry.

Sources: Nevada System of Higher Education Board of Regents records, 2013 to 2019; UNLV news releases.

On the board's largest capital, contract, and compliance decisions, she named the risk early and set the condition for approval

Decision before the board	Risk she named	What she required
Launch of the UNLV School of Medicine 2014 to 2016	Volatile state revenue, accreditation timelines, and leadership transitions across partner institutions	→ Multi-scenario financial models before the board committed public capital
Medical education building Capital program	Project cost estimates growing well past the original $100 million baseline	→ Firm cost targets set before any fundraising campaign launched
Stadium joint use agreement 2018	Game-day rent rising from about $50,000 to an estimated $250,000, with no express exit right	→ Pressed on the record for an exit clause; approval was conditioned on legal opinions confirming the university could exit without penalty
2017 to 2019 biennial budget 2016	Efficiency claims with no common method to verify them	→ Moved to standardize savings reporting and to redirect verified savings to instruction and student success
Title IX compliance 2015	Institutional liability from third-party personnel on campus and clinical sites	→ Extended training requirements to vendors, contractors, and clinical partners

Source: Nevada System of Higher Education Board of Regents meeting minutes, 2013 to 2018.

Financial and operating leadership

In managed care, she designed and ran a five-state value-based payment program that averaged $8.5 million in monthly savings

$8.5M

Average monthly savings

~$100M

Annualized savings across six years of operation

Five states

Arizona | Florida | North Carolina | South Carolina | Texas

Career progression

2006 to 2015
UnitedHealthcare
Advanced through multiple internal promotions to network program consultant

Program design
Value-based reimbursement
Designed the program and the network analytics that monitored and sustained it

2015 to 2018
DaVita Integrated Care
Senior manager, network development; extended the program to complex, underserved populations

Why it matters to a board

- Reads the drivers behind a P&L: utilization, unit cost, reimbursement, and network performance
- Turns complex financial and operating data into decisions management can execute and a board can rely on
- Knows healthcare reimbursement from the payer side, a growing exposure for employers and investors

Annualized figure is the monthly average multiplied by twelve. Source: UnitedHealthcare and DaVita Integrated Care program reporting.

For a national research funder, she designed a governance system that names six risks to outcomes and builds a control for each

Risk identified	Control she designed
Priorities chosen informally, with no documented process	→ Documented selection: three intake pathways, agreed allocations, and senior leadership sign-off
Investments drift from the problem they were meant to solve	→ Alignment worksheet and impact workbook at every gate, creating an auditable record
Teams selected for credentials over capacity to deliver	→ A team gate as the first competitive filter, before any proposal is written
Narrow, repeat review panels	→ A new, independent, diverse panel at each gate
Inconsistent rules on IP, data, AI, and conflicts of interest	→ One standing agreement that settles those terms across every funded consortium
Funding ends with no transition plan	→ A funded six-month off-ramp; no exit until a named steward is ready

Stage gates: capital narrows as evidence grows



A forward-only review rule credits candid reporting of failure, so problems surface early instead of late.

Validated against statute and strategy
Checked against Ireland's Research and Innovation Act 2024, the agency's 2026 to 2030 strategy, and international precedent.

SAFE: Strategic Analytical Framework for Evidence-based challenge funding. Developed as a Fulbright US Scholar at Research Ireland, the national research funding agency, 2025 to 2026.

Regulatory experience

Federal and state appointments put her inside the evidence reviews and regulatory decisions that shape regulated industries

2019 to 2027

MEDCAC

Appointed by the US Secretary of Health and Human Services

Voting member of the Medicare Evidence Development and Coverage Advisory Committee, reviewing the clinical evidence behind national Medicare coverage policy.

Board relevance

Coverage and reimbursement risk for healthcare, life sciences, and device companies

2026 to 2030

North Carolina Oil and Gas Commission

Appointed to a four-year term

Commissioner on the state body that sets rules for oil and gas activity in North Carolina.

Board relevance

Energy, environmental, and permitting risk; regulator perspective for industrial and utility boards

2026

IPCC expert reviewer

Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change

Expert reviewer for the Special Report on Climate Change and Cities.

Board relevance

Climate risk disclosure, physical risk, and sustainability oversight

State licensing and policy boards

Nevada State Board of Occupational Therapy, 2010 to 2015 (licensing). Nevada State Board of Education, 2016 to 2018. Nevada Legislative Subcommittee on Governance and Financing, 2013 to 2014. Nevada Vocational Rehabilitation Council, 2020 to 2021.

Appointing authorities as listed. Terms shown as appointed.

Eight years on a national governing board, with elected officer roles in its caucus and its climate council

8 years

Elected member of the Democratic National Committee, the national governing body of the Democratic Party

2 terms

2016 to 2024

Leadership role	Years
Member, two elected terms Democratic National Committee	2016 to 2024
Secretary DNC Black Caucus	2016 to 2025
Secretary Environmental and Climate Crisis Council	2020 to 2025
Director, Black Constituent Outreach Environmental and Climate Crisis Council	2017 to 2025

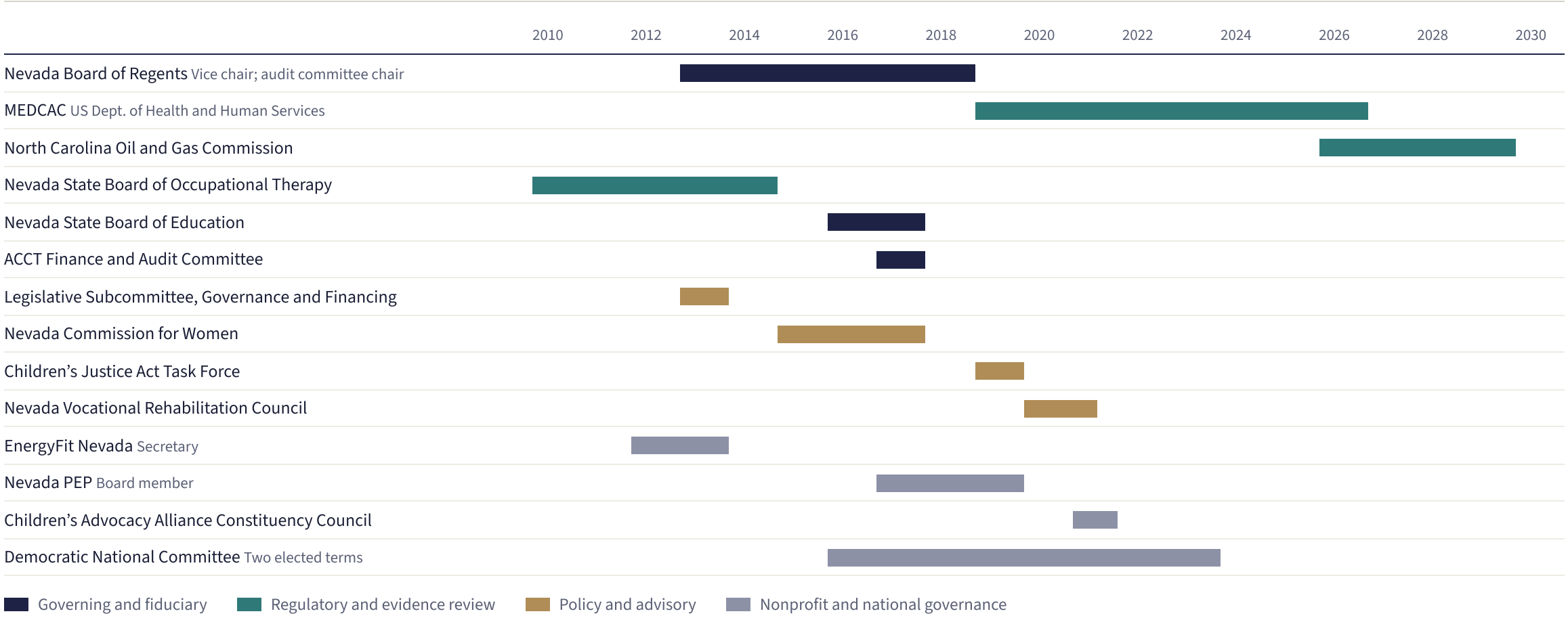
Why it matters to a board

- Governance of a large national organization: bylaws, rules, officer elections, and the record of a governing body
- Secretary roles carry the formal duties of minutes, records, and procedural integrity
- Climate policy leadership and stakeholder engagement with national reach

Recognition in this period: Women in Politics Lifetime Achievement Award, Urban Chamber of Commerce, 2016; Congressional Commendation, US Representative Dina Titus, 2016.

Governance record

Continuous board and commission service since 2010, across education, health, energy, and national governance



Selected seats. Bars show term years.

Board fit

She is ready to contribute from the first meeting on the audit, risk, and governance committees

Committee fit

Audit

- Chaired a system audit and compliance committee
- Redesigned internal audit and ERM; cut open exceptions 68 percent
- Published on audit committee governance

Committee fit

Risk and compliance

- Built anticipatory risk review into capital and contract decisions
- Designed a control-based governance framework for a national funder
- Federal and state regulatory appointments

Committee fit

Governance and sustainability

- Vice chair of a public system board; chaired a presidential search
- Eight years on a national governing board; fifteen boards since 2010
- Healthcare, energy, and climate oversight experience

Allison Alimayu, PhD

PhD, Biomedical Informatics, Rutgers University

Recognition

Fulbright US Scholar, 2025 to 2026
Distinguished Public Service Award, 2019
Distinguished Women of Nevada, 2014

Contact

info@alimayu.studio
alimayu.studio/board-seats.html